

CHAPTER TEN

THE GESTURES OF OTHER LIMBS

The breast

1. The breast is known to be of five kinds : Ābhugna (slightly bent), Nirbhugna (unbent), Prakampita (shaking), Udvāhita (raised) and Sama (natural).

2. Ābhugna (slightly bent)—(the breast) lowered, back high, shoulders slightly bent and at times loose (not stiff).

3. (Uses) : in hurry, despair, fainting, sorrow, fear, sickness, broken heart, touching of cold objects, rains and being ashamed of some act.

4. Nirbhugna (unbent)—(the breast) stiff, back depressed, shoulders not bent and raised.

5. (Uses) : in paralysis, having resentment, look of surprise, assertion of truth, mentioning oneself haughtily, and excess of pride.

6. Prakampita (shaken)—the breast incessantly heaved up [and down].

7. (Uses) : in laughter, weeping, weariness, panic, [fit of] asthma, hiccough, and misery.

8. Udvāhita (raised)—the breast raised up.

(Uses) : in (representing) deep breathing, viewing some lofty [object], and yawning.

9. Sama (natural)—All the limbs being in the Caturasra and with Sauṣṭhava the breast will be called Sama (natural).

1 (B.IX.223, G.1).

2 (B.IX.224, G.2).

3 (B.IX.225, G.3).

4 (B.IX.226, G.4).

5 (B.IX.227, G.5). ¹ B.G. read after this an additional couplet.

6 (B.IX.229, G.7).

7 (B.IX.230, G.8).

8 (B.IX.231, G.9).

9 (B.IX.232, G.10).

The sides

10. I have properly described the variety of the breast movements. And I shall now define here the two sides.

11. The sides are of five kinds, viz., Nata (bent), Samunnata (raised), Prasārita (extended), Virvartita (turned round) and Apasṛta (drawn away).

12-15. Nata (bent)—the waist slightly bent, one side slightly bent, one shoulder drawn away slightly.

Unnata (raised)—The other side [on the assumption of the Nata position] will be Unnata (raised), [because in relation of it] the waist, the side, the arm and the shoulder will be raised.

Prasārita (stretched)—the stretching of the sides in their (respective) directions.

Vivartita (turned round)—the Trika (sacrum) is to be turned round.

Prasṛta (drawn away)—the side restored to its original position from the Vivartita movement [described above].

These are the definition of the various kinds of sides.

Uses of the sides

16-17. Nata (bent)—in approaching any body.

Unnata (raised)—in going backwards.

Prasārita (stretched)—in joy and the like.

Vivartita (turned round) —in turning about.

Apasṛta (drawn away)—in returning.

These are the uses of sides. Now listen about those of the belly

The belly

18. The belly is of three kinds : Kṣāma (thin), Khalva (depressed), and Pūrṇa (full). Of these, the thin (belly) is Kṣāma, the bent is Khalva and the full belly is Pūrṇa.

10 (B.IX.233, G.11).

11 (B.IX.234, G.12).

12-15 (B.IX.235-238, G.13-16). ' B reads *nivartita*.

16-17 (B.IX. 239-240, G.17-18). 18 (B.IX.241, G.19).

Uses of the belly

19-20. *Kṣāma*, (*thin*) : in laughter, weeping, inhalation and yawning.

Khalva (depressed) : in sickness, penance (*tapas*), weariness and hunger.

Pūrṇa (full) : in emitting breath, fatness, disease, too much eating and the like.

These are the uses of the belly. Now listen about that of the waist.

The waist

21-24. The waist in dance and drama is of five kinds, viz. *Chinnā* (turned aside), *Nivṛttā*, (turned round), *Recitā* (moved about), *Prakampitā* = *Kampitā* (shaken) and *Udvāhitā* (raised).

Chinnā (turned aside)—in turning the middle of the waist.

Nivṛttā (turned round)—in turning to the front from the reverse position.

Recitā (moved about)—in moving in all directions.

Prakampitā (shaken)—in obliquely moving up and down.

Udvāhitā (raised)—in raising the two sides of the waist slowly.

These are the movements of the waist. Now listen about their uses.

Uses of the waist

25-26. *Chinnā* (turned aside) : in exercising [the limbs], hurry and looking round.

Nivṛttā (turned round) : in turning round.

Recitā (moved about) : in movements [of the general type].

Prakampitā (shaken) : in the walking of hunch-backs and persons of the inferior type.

19-20 (B.IX.242-243a, 244a, G.20-21). ¹ B.G. read an additional hemistich between 20a and 20b.

21-24 (B.IX.244b-248a, G.22-25). ¹ B.G. read differently.

25-26 (B.IX.248b-250a, G.26-27).

Udvāhita (raised) : in the [movement of] corpulent [persons] and the amorous movements of women.

The thigh

27-30. The thighs have five conditions, viz. Kampana (shaking) Valana (turning), Stambhana (motionlessness), Udvartana (springing up) and Vivartana (turning round).

31. Kampana (shaking)—raising and lowering of heels repeatedly.

Valana (turning)—drawing the knees inwards [while going].

Stambhana (motionlessness)—suspension of movement.

Udvartana (springing up)—drawing the knee inwards (*valita*) and moving it.

Vivartana (turning round)—drawing the heels inwards.

Uses of the thigh

32. Kampana (shaking) : in the frightened movement of persons of the inferior type.

Valana (turning) : in the movement of women at ease.

Stambhana (motionlessness) : in perturbation and despair.

Udvartana (springing up) : in exercising [the limbs] and the Class Dance.

Vivartana (turning round) : in going round due to causes like hurry.

33. Similar other [conditions of the thigh] as they are found in popular practice, may be assumed. So much about the description of the thigh. Now listen about the shank.

The shank

34-37. The shank is of five kinds, viz. Āvartita (turned) Nata (bent), Kṣipta (thrown out), Udvāhita (raised) and Parivṛtta (turned back).

27-30 (B.IX.250b-253, G.28-31a).

30-32 (B.IX.254-256a, G.31b-33).

33 (B.IX.256b-257a, G.34).

34-37 (B.IX.257b-258a, G.35).

Āvartita (turned)—the left foot turning to the right and the right [one] to the left.¹

Nata (bent)—the knee bent.

Kṣipta (thrown out)—shank thrown out.¹

Udvāhita (raised)—raising [a shank] up.

Parivṛtta (turned back)—the turning back [of a shank].

Uses of the shank

38-40. Āvartita (turned) : in the Jester's walking.

Nata (bent) : in assuming Sthāna (standing) and Āsana (sitting) postures,

Kṣipta (thrown out) : in the exercise [of limbs] and the Class Dance.

Udvāhita (raised) : in movements like quick (*āviddha*) walking.

Parivṛtta (turned back) : in Class Dance and the like.

These are the movements of the shank. Now listen about the movement of the feet.

The feet and their uses

41-50. The feet are of five kinds, viz. Udghaṭṭita, Sama, Agratalasañcara, Añcita and Kuñcita.

Udghaṭṭita—standing on the fore part of the feet and then touching the ground with the heels.

(Use) : In practice this is to follow the Udghaṭṭita Karaṇa and this should be applied once or more in the high or medium speed.

Sama (natural)—[feet] naturally placed on an even ground. It relates to representing a natural posture.

(Use) : It should be kept still in representing the natural

38-40 (B.IX.262b-263a, G.39).

41-50 (B.IX.265b-270a, 273b-278a, G.42-45, 47-52). ¹ B. adds three additional couplets after 45, and G. adds one additional couplet after 44.

² B. reads *stḥita* for *kṣata* meaning 'wound'.

position of the body in connexion with the various Karaṇas, but in the Recaka movement of the feet it should be moved.

Agratalasañcara—the heels thrown up, the big toe put forward and the other toes bent.

(Uses): This [is to be used] in urging, breaking, standing posture (*sthānaka*), kicking, striking the ground, walking, throwing away [something], various Recaka movements and walking on the forepart [of the foot] due to an wound at the heel.

Añcita—the heels on the ground, the forepart of the feet raised and all the toes spread.

(Uses); It is to be applied in representing a movement with wound at the forepart of the foot, turning round in every way, foot being struck [by something] and in various Bhramari movements.

Kuñcita—the heels thrown up, toes all bent down and the middle of the feet too bent.

51. (Uses): It is to be used in aristocratic (*udātta*) going, turning round to the right and *vice versa* and the Atikrāntā Cāri.

The Cāris

52. Persons practising [the Cāris] should take up simultaneously the movements of the feet, the shanks and the thighs. [For] in the movement of feet are included all the movements of the shanks and the thighs.

53. The thighs follow the way in which the feet are moved, and these two [limbs] constitute together the Cāri of the feet.

54. These are the descriptions and uses of the [various] limbs. I shall now describe the System of the [different] Cāris.

Here ends Chapter X. of Bharata's Nāṭyaśāstra,
which treats of the Gestures of other Limbs

51 (B.IX.278-279a, G.53). ¹ B. reads after this three additional hemistichs which define the Sūci foot as follows: The [right foot with its] heel raised resting on the big toe and the left foot in the natural position constitute the Sūci feet. It is used in dance and playing the Nūpura.

52 (B.IX.281, G.56).

53 (B.IX.282, G.57).

54 (B.IX.283, G.58).